





(ELISA – enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay) and molecular assays (PCR, real-time PCR). Besides its main scope, this PT gave also the following opportunities: (i) to perform a test performance studies (TPS) for the molecular protocols reported in the EPPO diagnostic protocol PM [7/24](#) (2) and use the data recovered from the laboratories that were scored as “proficient” (i.e. assessed as ‘conform and satisfactory laboratories’); (ii) to train the laboratories with little or no experience on *X. fastidiosa* diagnosis.

The analysis of the data from the proficiency test showed that different laboratories were proficient for different tests selected and described in the EPPO diagnostic protocol PM 7/24 (2).

The next step will be to perform, by the end of 2017, the interlaboratory comparison of molecular tests for the identification of the bacterium in the insect vector *Phlaenus spumarius*.

Project ID: Harmonized protocol for monitoring and detection of *Xylella fastidiosa* in its host plants and its vectors. (PROMODE).